

COMPANIES AND
GEOPOLITICAL RISKS

Geopolitical Competition in the Black Sea

Implications and Risks
for International Business

NEOMA Business School, Reims Campus
Course: Companies and Geopolitical Risks
Professor: Yassine OMRI
Academic Year 2025-2026

Table of Contents

I.	Introduction: The Black Sea as a Strategic Fulcrum	3
II.	Key Actors and Their Competing Interests	4
III.	Ten Types of Geopolitical Risk Applied to the Black Sea	5
IV.	Measuring Geopolitical Risk	8
V.	Implications for International Business	9
VI.	Anticipating and Managing GPR: The UAMR Framework	10
VII.	Conclusion	11
	Sources and References	12

I. Introduction: The Black Sea as a Strategic Fulcrum

The Black Sea has emerged as the most consequential arena of great-power competition in the world today, with direct and measurable consequences for global business. Since Russia's full-scale invasion of Ukraine in February 2022, the region has generated the highest Geopolitical Risk Index reading in fifty years (167.3), triggered a **\$167 billion** exodus of foreign corporate assets from Russia, and disrupted trade corridors carrying **34% of global wheat exports** alongside the last remaining pipeline for Russian gas to Europe.

Six littoral states ring the Black Sea: **Turkey, Russia, Ukraine, Romania, Bulgaria, and Georgia**. The sole maritime exit runs through the Turkish-controlled Bosphorus and Dardanelles straits, governed by the **Montreux Convention of 1936**, which grants Turkey sovereign discretion over warship transit. On 27 February 2022, Turkey invoked Montreux's wartime provisions for the first time since World War II, closing the straits to belligerent warships. This single decision froze the military balance: Russia could not reinforce its Black Sea Fleet, and NATO could not project additional naval power into the basin.

The region's economic weight is enormous. Russia and Ukraine together held a 34% share of global wheat exports in the pre-war period, with 95% of Ukraine's wheat transiting Black Sea ports. Energy corridors are equally critical: the **TurkStream pipeline** (31.5 bcm/year capacity) and **Blue Stream pipeline** (16 bcm/year) together represent 47.5 bcm of annual gas transport across the Black Sea seabed. After the expiration of Ukraine's gas transit contract on 31 December 2024, TurkStream became the **sole remaining pipeline route** for Russian gas to reach EU markets, operating at 98% utilization by February 2025.

The post-Cold War order in the region unravelled in stages. Russia's **2008 war with Georgia** established a precedent of military intervention. The **2014 annexation of Crimea** fundamentally altered the security architecture. The **February 2022 full-scale invasion** transformed the Black Sea into an active theater of war. Ukraine's innovative use of naval drones destroyed approximately one-third of Russia's Black Sea Fleet (at least 29 of 80 vessels), forcing the fleet's relocation from its historic base at Sevastopol to Novorossiysk by July 2024. The British Ministry of Defence declared the fleet 'functionally inactive' in March 2024.

II. Key Actors and Their Competing Interests

Russia: Neo-Imperial Ambitions

Russia pursues what Chatham House describes as a 'neo-imperial' vision for the Black Sea. Its immediate strategic objective is to sever Ukraine from its Black Sea coastline, secure the land bridge to Crimea, and establish dominance over maritime trade routes. Despite catastrophic fleet losses, Russia has adapted by relocating assets to Novorossiysk and exploring a new naval facility in Ochamchire, Abkhazia (occupied Georgian territory). Russia's energy leverage is concentrated in TurkStream, which delivered 16.7 bcm to the EU in 2024, a 23% increase over 2023. Moscow also weaponizes grain exports as political leverage and deploys hybrid warfare (cyberattacks, disinformation, election interference, sabotage) across the region.

NATO: Reinforcing the Southeastern Flank

NATO recognized the Black Sea's strategic importance in its 2022 Strategic Concept for the first time. Eight multinational battlegroups now line the eastern flank, including an Italy-led battlegroup in Bulgaria and a France-led battlegroup in Romania. The US maintains approximately 2,000 personnel at Romania's Mihail Kogalniceanu Air Base, which is undergoing a multibillion-dollar expansion. In January 2024, Romania, Turkey, and Bulgaria activated a **trilateral Mine Countermeasures Task Force**, the first dedicated Black Sea naval security mechanism. However, the 2025 US National Security Strategy signals a shift toward the Indo-Pacific, meaning European allies must shoulder greater responsibility for the region's security.

European Union: A Late but Ambitious Strategy

The EU published its first comprehensive Black Sea strategy on **28 May 2025**, built on three pillars: security and resilience (including a new Maritime Security Hub), sustainable growth and connectivity, and climate resilience. However, the German Marshall Fund assessed the strategy as having 'right goals, unclear means,' noting it lacks a concrete action plan, timeline, or dedicated budget. The EU's 19 sanctions packages against Russia represent the most complex restrictive measures regime in history, targeting over 2,400 individuals and entities and immobilizing approximately **210 billion euros** in Russian Central Bank assets.

Turkey: The Indispensable Balancer

Turkey occupies a unique position as both Montreux Convention gatekeeper and NATO's second-largest military. Ankara has simultaneously supplied Ukraine with Bayraktar TB2 combat drones while maintaining close economic ties with Moscow. Turkey's energy hub ambitions are substantial, with new LNG deals signed with Shell, TotalEnergies, and ExxonMobil. But its dependence on Russian gas (40-42% of imports) and the Rosatom-built Akkuyu nuclear plant creates structural vulnerability.

China: The New Player

China has emerged through the **Anaklia deep-sea port project** in Georgia, awarded to a consortium led by China Communications Construction Company (CCCC) for \$600 million. This positions Anaklia as a critical node on the Middle Corridor (Trans-Caspian route linking China to Europe while bypassing Russia). Western analysts warn that Chinese construction gives Beijing influence over a key Europe-Asia trade route, adding a new layer of geopolitical competition beyond the Russia-NATO binary.

III. Ten Types of Geopolitical Risk Applied to the Black Sea

1. Interstate Wars

The Russia-Ukraine war has directly militarized Black Sea commercial operations. Ukraine's naval drone campaign using MAGURA V5 unmanned surface vehicles (costing \$50,000-\$250,000 each against warships worth tens of millions) destroyed approximately one-third of the Russian Black Sea Fleet. War risk insurance premiums surged from a peacetime baseline of roughly 0.025% of vessel value to **1.0-1.2%**, a forty-fold increase, adding about \$1 million per voyage for a \$100 million vessel. In March 2026, Ukrainian drone strikes on the Novorossiysk oil terminal knocked out six of seven loading arms, demonstrating that commercial energy infrastructure remains a direct target. Cargo vessel arrivals at Ukrainian ports fell from 6,196 in 2021 to 5,327 in 2024.

2. International Conflicts and Humanitarian Crises

The war produced **5.9 million refugees**, the fastest-growing refugee crisis in Europe since World War II, and disrupted food supplies to over 400 million people globally dependent on Ukrainian grain. Wheat prices surged 58% in March 2022 compared to the prior year. Egypt imported 85% of its wheat from Russia and Ukraine; Lebanon sourced 66% from Ukraine and experienced food inflation of 2,300% over three years. The World Food Programme, which procured 80% of its wheat from Ukraine, was severely constrained. The collapse of the Black Sea Grain Initiative in July 2023 further destabilized food-insecure regions across Africa and the Middle East.

3. Laws, Regulations, and Public Policies

The EU sanctions architecture expanded from one package to **19 packages** in three years, creating enormous compliance burdens. Key measures include an oil embargo covering 90% of EU oil imports from Russia, SWIFT disconnection for 50 Russian banks, restrictions on nearly 600 shadow fleet vessels, and export controls on dual-use technologies including AI and quantum computing. Companies exiting Russia face a mandatory 60% discount on sale prices and a 35% 'exit tax' on transaction value, meaning firms may recover as little as 5% of actual asset value. Turkey's Montreux enforcement, while strategically decisive, also constrains NATO naval access, a dual-edged regulatory instrument.

4. Breaches of Contract and Expropriation

Russia has systematically seized foreign assets since 2022. The Kyiv School of Economics estimates total foreign company losses at **\$167 billion**, with at least \$57 billion in directly confiscated assets. Putin's Decree No. 520 (July 2023) placed Danone and Carlsberg operations under state control without compensation. BP recorded the largest single corporate loss: a \$25.5 billion write-down from its 19.75% Rosneft stake, which it cannot sell due to Russian court injunctions. Renault sold its Moscow plant and AvtoVAZ (Lada) stake for one rouble, absorbing a 2.2 billion euro write-down. In 2024, the Russian state seized 157 companies worth 1.1 trillion roubles; in Q1 2025, another 50 entities worth over 800 billion roubles. No specific legal criteria govern which assets are targeted: seizure is at presidential discretion.

5. Corruption and Political Interference

Russian interference in Black Sea state elections reached unprecedented scale in 2024. In Moldova's October 2024 EU referendum, approximately \$39 million was spent to bribe an estimated 130,000 voters (roughly 10% of the electorate), organized by fugitive oligarch Ilan Shor from Moscow. The referendum passed by a razor-thin 50.39% margin. In Georgia's parliamentary elections, ruling party Georgian Dream claimed 54% despite exit polls showing them at 41%, a 13-point discrepancy. Georgia subsequently abandoned its EU accession process, passed a Russian-style 'foreign agents' law, and saw the EU freeze 30 million euros in defense funding.

6. Extraterritorial Application of Law

The EU's 14th sanctions package (June 2024) introduced **Article 8a**, requiring EU parent companies to ensure their non-EU subsidiaries do not undermine sanctions. This is the first systematic extraterritorial extension of EU restrictive measures. The 'No-Russia Clause' mandates exporters contractually prohibit third-country buyers from re-exporting to Russia. US secondary sanctions under Executive Order 14024 target non-US persons providing material assistance to blocked entities. OFAC enforcement actions have produced significant penalties: IPI Partners (\$11.5 million), Gracetown Inc. (\$7.1 million). The practical effect is widespread overcompliance, where firms abandon legitimate business opportunities across the entire region for fear of sanctions violations, creating a chilling effect.

7. Manipulation of Natural Resources

Russia has systematically weaponized energy and food supplies. Pipeline gas deliveries to Europe fell from a pre-war peak of roughly 175-180 bcm/year to just 28.3 bcm in 2023, inflating European gas prices by over 400% at peak. The grain blockade of February to July 2022 trapped 25 million tonnes of Ukrainian grain and pushed 47 million people into severe hunger globally. Russia's withdrawal from the Black Sea Grain Initiative in July 2023 was accompanied by deliberate destruction of Odesa port infrastructure. Cynically, Russia's own wheat exports surged 48% to 49 million metric tonnes in 2023-24, benefiting from the higher global prices its own blockade created. Russia also leverages OPEC+ membership to coordinate oil production decisions.

8. Social Activism and Civil Society Pressure

The invasion triggered the largest corporate divestment movement since apartheid-era South Africa. Yale University tracked approximately 400 companies announcing withdrawal from Russia by March 2022. However, ESG frameworks proved inadequate: research from Duke University found that highly-rated ESG firms were neither more likely nor quicker to exit Russia. Refinitiv had assigned 15-30% higher Social and Human Rights scores to firms with Russian exposure versus peers without, a major failure of ESG screening. Consumer boycott pressure, exemplified by President Zelenskyy's public criticism of Nestle, became a reputational risk factor for firms maintaining Russian operations. Georgia's pro-EU protest movement mobilized over 100,000 demonstrators against the foreign agents law.

9. Terrorism and Political Violence

Infrastructure sabotage has escalated from the Nord Stream pipeline destruction (September 2022, 110 bcm combined capacity permanently disabled) to systematic drone attacks on Black Sea energy assets. In **March 2026**, Gazprom reported **12 attacks in two weeks** targeting the Russkaya, Beregovaya, and Kazachya compressor stations, which are the starting points for TurkStream and Blue Stream. While all attacks were reportedly repelled, Hungary's Foreign Minister Szijarto warned that without TurkStream, Hungary cannot be safely supplied with gas. Russia struck Ukrainian port infrastructure with 90 combined missile/drone attacks in 2025, cutting monthly grain shipments by up to 30%. Europe's gas storage stood at just 22-27%, far below the five-year average of 41%.

10. Cyber Threats and Cyberattacks

The Black Sea region has been a proving ground for the world's most consequential cyberattacks. The **NotPetya attack** (June 2017), launched through Ukrainian accounting software M.E.Doc, caused an estimated **\$10 billion in global damages**, the most destructive cyberattack in history. Maersk, handling 20% of global container shipping, lost all 150 domain controllers simultaneously; recovery took two months and cost \$200-300 million. FedEx/TNT Express suffered \$400 million in losses; Merck \$870 million. GPS spoofing in the Black Sea has become endemic: Lloyd's List Intelligence logged 1,735 GPS interference events affecting 655 vessels since 2022. Russia's GRU Unit 29155 and the Cadet Blizzard cyber group have been sanctioned by the EU.

IV. Measuring Geopolitical Risk in the Black Sea

A. Geopolitical Risk Index (GPR)

The GPR Index (Caldara and Iacoviello, *American Economic Review*, 2022) peaked at **167.3 in March 2022**, the highest reading in approximately fifty years, comparable only to Gulf War and Iraq invasion spikes. Federal Reserve econometric analysis estimates that a GPR shock of this magnitude reduces world GDP by approximately 1.7% cumulatively and raises global inflation by 1.3 percentage points. By contrast, the 2014 Crimea annexation produced no measurable global GDP impact, reflecting the limited scope of early sanctions. Academic research (Cambridge Core, 2024) confirms that Russia-specific GPR shocks produce statistically significant knock-on effects on advanced economies through energy price channels, trade disruption, and financial market contagion.

B. Sovereign Credit Ratings

Ratings reveal a stark risk stratification across the Black Sea region:

Country	Moody's	S&P	Fitch	Grade
Romania	Baa3 (Neg.)	BBB- (Neg.)	BBB-	Investment
Bulgaria	Baa1	BBB+	BBB	Investment
Turkey	Ba3	BB-	BB-	Speculative
Georgia	Ba2	BB	BB	Speculative
Ukraine	Ca	SD	CCC	Default
Russia	W/D	W/D	W/D	N/A

Romania and Bulgaria are the only investment-grade Black Sea states, making them the region's most attractive destinations for risk-averse investors. Turkey has been upgraded twice since 2024 following its return to orthodox monetary policy but remains three notches below investment grade. Russia collapsed from investment grade (Baa3) to complete ratings withdrawal within ten days of the February 2022 invasion, a historically unprecedented descent.

C. War Risk Insurance Premiums

Maritime war risk insurance provides the most real-time market measure of geopolitical risk. Premiums moved from a peacetime baseline of roughly 0.025% of vessel value to a peak of 1.0-1.5% for Black Sea port calls. Following the March 2026 drone attacks on Novorossiysk, insurers began reviewing terms every 24 hours rather than the standard seven-day cycle. A 150,000-tonne Suezmax tanker now pays an additional roughly \$200,000 per voyage in war-risk levies. The global war-risk premium market approached **\$1 billion** in early 2025. S&P; Global reported in December 2024 that Black Sea premiums were rising while Red Sea premiums were falling, reflecting a shift in the global risk landscape back toward Eastern Europe.

V. Implications for International Business

Shipping and Maritime Trade

Ukraine's unilateral grain corridor, established in August 2023 after Russia's withdrawal from the Grain Initiative, has shipped over **90 million tonnes** to 55 countries. However, it remains vulnerable: Russian strikes cut monthly shipments by up to 30% in 2025, leaving 10 million tonnes unsold and triggering a projected \$1 billion drop in Ukrainian export earnings for Q1 2026. The **Port of Constanta** in Romania emerged as the critical alternative hub, handling a record 92.7 million tonnes in 2023 (up 22.5% year-on-year) and seeing container throughput surge 62% from 610,000 TEU in 2021 to 990,000 TEU in 2024. Romania committed over \$300 million in infrastructure upgrades and aims to double monthly Ukrainian grain transit capacity.

Energy Sector

TurkStream operated at 89-98% utilization in early 2025, near physical capacity limits, while European gas storage fell to 22-27%, well below the 41% five-year average. Major oil companies absorbed staggering losses: BP (\$25.5 billion write-down), Shell (\$4-5 billion), TotalEnergies (\$14.8 billion), ExxonMobil (\$3.4 billion). The March 2026 drone attacks on TurkStream compressor stations, while repelled, demonstrate that Europe's last Russian gas pipeline could be disrupted at any moment. Analysts estimate that if TurkStream is taken offline, European gas prices could spike 30-50% within days, with Hungary, Serbia, and Bulgaria most immediately affected.

Agricultural Commodities

The FAO Food Price Index reached its highest level ever in March 2022. Wheat futures surged to approximately \$1,400/ton. The four major grain traders (Cargill, ADM, Bunge, Louis Dreyfus) each faced distinct dilemmas. Cargill, which owns a deep-sea port near Odesa, had a chartered vessel struck by a projectile on the first day of the invasion. ADM suspended all Ukrainian operations. Russia's own wheat exports paradoxically surged as higher global prices resulted from its own blockade, reaching a 28% global market share in 2023-24. USDA long-term projections indicate Ukraine's grain exports will not recover to pre-war levels before the end of the current decade.

Foreign Direct Investment

Romania has benefited significantly from nearshoring trends: FDI projects surged **57%** in 2024 (from 60 to 94 projects), with Transport and Logistics rising from 9th to 3rd place in sectoral ranking, a direct geopolitical-logistics effect. Romania ranked 2nd in Central and Eastern Europe for FDI attractiveness in EY's 2025 survey. Bulgaria's FDI inflows grew 48.4% in the first nine months of 2023. The Danube corridor, initially an emergency alternative for Ukrainian grain exports, has matured into a permanent logistics asset, with freight costs falling from \$100/ton in 2023 to approximately 10 euros/ton.

VI. Anticipating and Managing GPR: The UAMR Framework

The course framework proposes four steps for managing geopolitical risk: **Understand, Analyse, Mitigate, and Respond**. Applied to the Black Sea, each step requires specific adaptation to the compounding nature of the region's risk profile.

Understand	Analyse	Mitigate	Respond
Define risk appetite across all 10 GPR types. Romania/Bulgaria offer investment-grade stability. Turkey offers scale but volatility. Ukraine/Georgia are high risk.	Combine quantitative indicators (GPR Index, insurance premiums, TurkStream flow data, grain corridor volumes) with qualitative intelligence from think tanks.	Diversify supply chains away from single-corridor dependency. Invest in Constanta/Danube alternatives. Obtain MIGA political risk insurance.	Build crisis management teams. Plan for failure (not success). Capitalize on near misses. Develop continuous learning mechanisms.
Foster shared understanding across the organization. Create a common language for risk. Make political risk everyone's business, from boardroom to operations.	Use scenario planning: escalation (TurkStream strike), de-escalation (ceasefire), status quo. Avoid groupthink via the nine-dot exercise principle.	Implement robust sanctions compliance systems. Build flexible surge capacity for logistics rerouting. Align with industry peers for collective advocacy.	Evaluate the situation quickly, activate the team, communicate values, tell your story. Be aware of multiple audiences (investors, regulators, public).
Reduce blind spots through imagination, understanding others' perspectives, and truth-telling to guard against groupthink.	Integrate GPR analysis into business decisions: bake it in rather than bolting it on. Ensure analysts are embedded close to business units.	Build relationships with key stakeholders before crises. Develop contingency plans and 'tripwires' that trigger pre-approved protocols.	Use counterfactual analysis. Train, train, train. Continuously reinforce company values as a touchstone for action in uncertain moments.

BCG and the World Economic Forum found in January 2026 that fewer than **one in five companies** maintain a dedicated geopolitics department, despite geopolitical risk ranking as a top-three concern for global executives. McKinsey recommends a tiered geopolitical risk dashboard with markets classified by exposure level. For the Black Sea, critical signposts include: frequency of attacks on energy infrastructure, insurance premium trajectory, TurkStream utilization rates, grain corridor shipping volumes, and ceasefire negotiation status.

The vulnerability-value matrix from the course is directly applicable. High-value, high-vulnerability assets in the Black Sea (such as TurkStream compressor stations, Odesa port grain terminals, or the Constanta rail link) require top-priority risk management attention. Companies like Sony (whose unreleased scripts were stolen by North Korean hackers) and SeaWorld (vulnerable to activist campaigns) illustrate the principle that risk management priorities should be set by the intersection of asset value and vulnerability to disruption, not by the probability of disruption alone.

VII. Conclusion

The Black Sea region has transitioned from a post-Cold War periphery to the central theater of European security competition, and this transition is irreversible regardless of how the Russia-Ukraine war concludes. Three structural features make this risk environment permanent rather than cyclical.

First, TurkStream's near-capacity utilization as Europe's sole Russian gas conduit creates a single point of failure that any future crisis will weaponize. The March 2026 drone attacks demonstrated this vulnerability is not theoretical. If TurkStream is successfully sabotaged, Europe loses its last Russian pipeline gas route at a time when gas storage levels stand at dangerously low levels.

Second, China's Anaklia port investment signals the Black Sea's integration into broader Eurasian great-power competition beyond the Russia-NATO binary. The region is becoming a node in the Belt and Road Initiative's Middle Corridor, meaning that commercial decisions in the Black Sea now carry implications for the US-China rivalry as well.

Third, the precedent of systematic asset expropriation (\$167 billion in foreign losses, seizures governed by presidential discretion without legal criteria) has permanently altered the risk calculus for foreign direct investment in adversarial states globally. Any firm operating in a jurisdiction where the rule of law is subordinate to political authority must now factor in a non-trivial probability of total asset loss.

For international business, the Black Sea is not a single risk but a **compounding risk environment** where interstate war, cyber threats, sanctions complexity, energy coercion, and democratic backsliding interact and amplify each other. Companies that treat these risks in silos will underperform those that adopt integrated geopolitical risk frameworks. The firms best positioned are those that have diversified their logistics corridors, embedded geopolitical intelligence into capital allocation, and built the organizational capacity to pivot rapidly when the next escalation arrives.

Sources and References

Think Tanks & Policy Research

- Delay, G. and Sabanadze, N. (2024). 'How geopolitical competition in the Black Sea is redefining regional order.' Chatham House Expert Comment, March 2024.
- Delay, G. et al. (2025). 'Understanding Russia's Black Sea strategy.' Chatham House Research Paper, July 2025.
- Dupuy, A.C. (2025). 'How NATO and its partners should respond to Russia's militarization of the wider Black Sea region.' Atlantic Council TURKEYSource, December 2025.
- Friedrich Naumann Foundation (2024). 'Securing the Black Sea: NATO, EU Integration and the Russian Federation.' Tbilisi, October 2024.
- German Marshall Fund (2025). 'The EU's New Black Sea Security Strategy: Right Goals, Unclear Means.' June 2025.
- RUSI (2025). 'A Strategy Long Overdue: The EU's New Vision for the Black Sea.' Royal United Services Institute, June 2025.
- George C. Marshall Center (2024). 'A New Security Reality: Strategic Approaches for the Wider Black Sea Region.'
- NATO Parliamentary Assembly (2025). 'Black Sea Report.' Economics and Security Committee, Ljubljana.
- CEPA (2025). 'The Hybrid Threat Imperative: Deterring Russia Before It Is Too Late.' December 2025.
- College of Europe (2025). 'The Black Sea: Europe's Strategic Frontier and the EU's Emerging Maritime Vision.' Natolin.

Official & Institutional Sources

- European Commission (2025). 'New EU strategy for a secure, prosperous and resilient Black Sea region.' Joint Communication, 28 May 2025.
- European Council / Consilium (2024-2026). EU Sanctions packages against Russia (1st through 19th). Brussels.
- European Council (2025). 'Russian hybrid threats: Council sanctions twelve individuals and two entities.' 15 December 2025.
- NATO (2022). 'NATO 2022 Strategic Concept.' Madrid Summit, June 2022.
- United Nations (2022-2023). 'Black Sea Grain Initiative: Operational updates.' July 2022 to July 2023.
- UNHCR (2024). 'Ukraine Refugee Crisis: Aid, Statistics and News.' USA for UNHCR.

Legal Framework

- Montreux Convention Regarding the Regime of the Straits (1936). Signed 20 July 1936, Montreux, Switzerland.
- Bloomsbury Intelligence and Security Institute (2025). 'Montreux Convention, Bosphorus Strait and the Making of Naval Power in the Black Sea.' November 2025.
- U.S. Naval Institute (2022). 'Turkey, the Montreux Convention, and Russian Navy Transits.' Proceedings, March 2022.
- Lieber Institute, West Point (2024). 'The Montreux Convention and Turkey's Impact on Black Sea Operations.' September 2024.

Energy & Pipelines

- Caspian Post (2026). 'Turkey's Energy Security: TurkStream, Blue Stream and TANAP.' March 2026.
- Turkiye Today (2026). '12 attacks on TurkStream and Blue Stream infrastructure repelled: Gazprom.' March 2026.
- PA Turkey (2026). 'Attacks on TurkStream Facilities Raise Energy Security Concerns.' March 2026.
- Atlantic Council (2024). 'Turkey's geopolitical role in the Black Sea and European energy security.' September 2024.
- Atlantic Council (2025). 'Turkey can become an energy hub, but not by going all-in on Russian gas.' July 2025.
- Interfax (2026). 'European branch of TurkStream pipeline utilization drops to 80% in March.' March 2026.

Trade, Shipping & Commodities

- S&P; Global (2025). 'FACTBOX: Black Sea grains trade sees shift amid potential peace deal.' March 2025.
- UkrAgroConsult (2025). 'Escalation in the Black Sea raises risks for global grain exports.' December 2025.
- CSIS (2024). 'The State of Maritime Supply-Chain Threats.' November 2024.
- Council on Foreign Relations (2024). 'How Ukraine Overcame Russia's Grain Blockade.' February 2024.
- AgroReview (2025). 'War Risk Premiums in the Black Sea: Current Trends & Insights.'
- Ship Universe (2025). 'The Top 8 Regions Driving Up War Risk Premiums in 2025.'

Business Impact & Corporate Cases

- Kyiv Post (2025). 'Foreign Businesses in Russia Lost \$167 Billion: Assets Redirected to Kremlin.'
- OSW Centre for Eastern Studies (2025). 'Putin's elite divides the spoils: large-scale nationalisation.' September 2025.
- BCG / World Economic Forum (2026). 'Fewer than One in Five Companies Have a Dedicated Geopolitics Department.' January 2026.
- McKinsey (2024). 'Geopolitical resilience: the new board imperative.'
- EY (2025). 'Bridging Confidence and Commitment: Romania's path to sustainable FDI growth.'

Northwave Cybersecurity (2025). 'Russia's Hybrid Threats to Europe's Businesses.'

Gibson Dunn (2024). 'The Long Arm of EU Sanctions: Latest sanctions extend to non-EU subsidiaries.'

Academic Sources

Caldara, D. and Iacoviello, M. (2022). 'Measuring Geopolitical Risk.' *American Economic Review*, 112(4): 1194-1225.

Bastug, S. et al. (2024). 'Assessment of the Black Sea Grain Initiative: Crisis Management via Maritime Transportation.' *Transport Policy*.

Anghel, L. (2025). 'Analysis of Hybrid Risks and Information Warfare in the Black Sea Region.' *J. Int. Scient. Re. Rep.*

Cambridge Core (2024). 'Economic knock-on effects of Russia's geopolitical risk on advanced economies.' *Macroeconomic Dynamics*.

Small Wars Journal (2025). 'From Tanks to TikTok: Adapting Article 5 for Graduated Responses to Hybrid Warfare.' July 2025.